which could otherwise be tested for weapon systems.

8. ***Convention on Prohibition of Military or Other Hostile Use of Environment Modification Techniques, 1977:*** This Convention opened for signature in Geneva on 18 May 1977 and came into force on 5 October 1978.

Article I contains provisions under which each state Parties to the Convention undertook not to engage in military or any other hostile use of environmental modification techniques having widespread, long-lasting or severe effects as the means of destruction, damage or injury to any other state Party. The Treaty also required that each state Party should refrain from assisting, encouraging or inducing any state, group of states or international organization to engage in activities contrary to the provisions of this article.

Under Article III, the state Parties to this Convention further undertook responsibility to facilitate, and have the right to participate in, the fullest possible exchange of scientific and technological information on the use of environmental modification techniques for peaceful purposes. The provisions of the Treaty also upheld co-operation among states parties and other states or international organizations, to international economic and scientific cooperation for the preservation, improvement and peaceful utilization of the environment, with due consideration for the needs of the developing areas of the world.

9. ***Strategic Arms Limitation Talks (SALT II):*** This was the second round of talks from 1972 to 1979 between the United States and the Soviet Union and signified the continuation of the progress made during the SALT I talks which aimed at curtailing the manufacture of strategic nuclear weapons. This Treaty was to remain in force for five years. It talked about real reductions in strategic forces to 2,250 of all categories of delivery vehicles on both sides, such as the ICBM launchers, Long Range Bombers and SLBMs. A ceiling was also imposed on Multiple Independently Targetable Reentry Vehicles (MIRVs), and provisions were included for slowing down the pace of new strategic weapons.

Six months after the signing of the Treaty, the Soviet deployment of troops in Afghanistan and refusal of the American Senate to formally